METRIC

A-A-54876
21 May 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Military Specifications MIL-S-37092 which is cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers absorbable gelatin sponges.

Salient characteristics:

General. Shall be an absorbable gelatin sponge suitable for use as a local hemostatic in oral and dental surgery. Shall be capable of absorbing and holding whole blood within its meshes. Shall be the following types

Type I	-	20 by 20 by 7mm, 15s
Type II	-	20 by 60 by 7mm, 12s
Type III	-	80 by 125 by 10mm, 6s

Material. Shall be a light, nearly white, pliable, non-antigenic, non-elastic, tough, porous matrix. Shall be in accordance with the tests, standards, and requirements of the United States Pharmacopeia (USP).

Absorbability. When implanted in tissues, the absorbable gelatin sponge shall be completely absorbed in from four to six weeks without including excessive skin tissue formation.

AMSC N/A FSC 6510

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Absorbability testing shall be performed on one lot for one contract provided the contractor certifies that the manufacturing procedure for each subsequent lot and contract is identical to the procedure used to manufacture the one lot subjected to the absorbability test. On subsequent contracts, the supplier shall submit certification that the lots offered to the Government were manufactured identically as the material subjected to the absorbability test.

Heat durability. The absorbable gelatin sponge shall withstand a dry heat at 95°C for four hours without showing decomposition. The darkening in color from yellow to slightly brown of the absorbable gelatin sponge is not considered decomposition of the material.

Dimensions. Each absorbable gelatin sponge shall comply with the measurements specified below for the appropriate type:

	Width	Height	Thickness
Type I	18 to 22mm	18 to 22mm	5.3 to 9.8mm
Type II	18 to 22mm	52.5 to 67.5mm	5.3 to 9.8mm
Type III	70 to 90mm	110 to 150mm	8 to 12.5mm

At least ten sponges shall be examined to determine whether the sponges comply with the above dimensions. Not more than one sponge shall deviate from the above by more than ± 15% in width, ± 15% in height, and ± 30% in thickness.

Non-toxicity, prugencity and sterility. The sponge shall be non toxic and pyrogen free when tested in accordance with United States Pharmacopeia (USP). The sponge shall be tested for sterility in accordance with USP or AAMI requirements. Sterility assurance level shall be 0.000001.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Unit.

For Size 1 - Jar (JR). One jar containing 15 absorbable gelatin sponges, as specified, constitutes one unit. Jar shall be capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless damaged or opened.

For Size 2 - Box (BX). Each sponge shall be individually packaged in a white paper envelope (inner envelope) and enclosed in a sealed, peel-open envelope capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless damaged or opened. One box containing 12 individually packaged sponges, as specified, constitutes one unit.

For Size 3 - Box (BX). Each sponge shall be individually packaged in a white paper envelope (inner envelope) and enclosed in a sealed, peel-open envelope capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless damaged or opened. One box containing 6 individually packaged sponges, as specified, constitutes one unit.

QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Lot. A lot, batch, or control is that single, uniform, and homogeneous quantity of absorbable gelatin sponge produced from one formulation, subjected to the same compounding and manufacturing operations, and placed into the final containers.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

PLEASE OMIT THIS DOCUMENT ARE MET

Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and simultaneously sterilized in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a lot (control) number and expiration date as specified in the labeling requirements. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

Upon approval of the procuring activity, the assigning of pharmaceutical lot (quality control) numbers without showing individual load (charge) designation (sterility lot) will be acceptable, provided samples from each sterilizer charge are tested and reserve samples representing each sterilizer charge are retained for future testing, as needed.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one sponge. Sampling shall be Inspection level II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 1.0.

Examination. Examination shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. Unit of product for test purposes shall be one sponge. Sampling shall be Inspection level S-2 with an AQL of 1.0.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerance specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction , the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered material. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

NSN	Item Identification	Size
6510-00-064-4858	SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP, 20 by 20 by 7mm, 15s.	1
6510-00-080-2053	SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP, 20 by 60 by 7mm, 12s.	2
6510-00-080-2054	SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP, 80 by 125 by 10mm, 6s.	3

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6510-0851

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER A-A-54876	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 21 May 1993

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
SPONGE, ABSORBABLE GELATIN, USP

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. [illegible]	b. ORGANIZATION
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)
	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial , (2) AUTOVON
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340

DD Form 1426, OCT 89 Previous editions are obsolete '98

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20260-26109:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.